

Phase One

Yay! You did it. Welcome to Phase One.

Phase One is the activation phase. It's time for your body to start pulling out toxins from your cells. Keep in mind that you will continue eating like you have been in the Preparation Phase. But, you'll be compounding on that diet now. The exception is that you'll be adding a whole lot of berries. You'll continue eating protein because you need amino acids, which are essential for Phase Two. During this phase, you'll continue eating your leafy greens, cruciferous veggies, proteins, and antioxidant fruits (berries and citrus). For those who are strictly plant-based, you can have high amino acid protein substitutes like lentils, quinoa, and chickpeas. Refer to the food category list.

During Phase One, liver detox enzymes called cytochrome P450 will begin to convert toxins from fat-soluble to smaller, intermediate substances, which are very harmful. The berries are needed because they are high in antioxidants and will help to neutralize the toxins before they harm your liver. Keep in mind that there is a sequential pattern that will start to happen. Phase Two is right behind. Think of it like a factory assembly line. Phase One prepares toxins for immediate neutralization by Phase Two. It's like a tandem system. This is to prevent cellular damage.

Pay close attention because this is also where you'll also begin using the **oil of oregano**—your secret weapon. As you're using the oil, you're consuming the berries. Because pure Mediterranean oil of oregano is very potent, it should be introduced during Phase One. If it's used too early while you're in the Preparation Phase, then you can prematurely cause intense Herxheimer reactions or "die-off" symptoms especially if your detoxification pathways aren't open yet. The point of the Preparation Phase is to begin to adjust your diet and habits so that your body can begin to stabilize, your drainage pathways can open up, and you can reduce inflammation before pathogens begin to die and release their toxins in your bloodstream. This is why it's very important to consume lots of probiotic-rich foods from the very start to replenish good bacteria. It may seem like a lot is happening all at once, but stay calm and focused. Trust the process. Once you follow the steps, it'll feel easier. You're building a routine. Get into the rhythm. You got this!

⚠️ You need to be having daily bowel movements **before** you begin using the oil of oregano.

